

to connect to yours, and when you are done surfing, turn off the Wi-Fi card.

- Set your Wi-Fi connection to use WPA or WEP encryption if the hotspot supports it. If the hotspot access point does not support encryption, all your data is being transmitted in clear text and can be easily intercepted by hackers. While data to HTTPS sites will be encrypted and relatively secure, regular e-mail and other traffic can still be read. Password-lock sensitive attachments and inform the recipient of the password by other means (phone, SMS, pre-agreed, or any other means you can think of).
- Use a personal firewall to prevent hackers from probing your system for open ports.
- Use an anti-virus solution to protect your laptop from virus attacks.
- Verify the overall security of your system by using Microsoft Baseline Security Analyzer.
- Test the overall security of your system by running the free tests at Gibson Research (<https://www.grc.com/x/ne.dll?bh0bkyd2>)
- When sending and receiving e-mail, don't use an e-mail client like Outlook, Thunderbird, Outlook Express, etc. Use Web-based e-mail that supports SSL or HTTPS. This will ensure that all mail data is encrypted between your laptop and the mail server.
- Be aware of people around you. Somebody may be looking over your shoulder and noting down any information you are typing. This may sound a bit extreme, but most identity thieves snoop around public places. Remember Andy Grover: "Only the paranoid survive!"

9.1.4. Security accessories

- Use a cable and lock to secure your laptop. Most laptops come with the Universal Security Slot for this purpose. Use a good qual-